

Vertigo

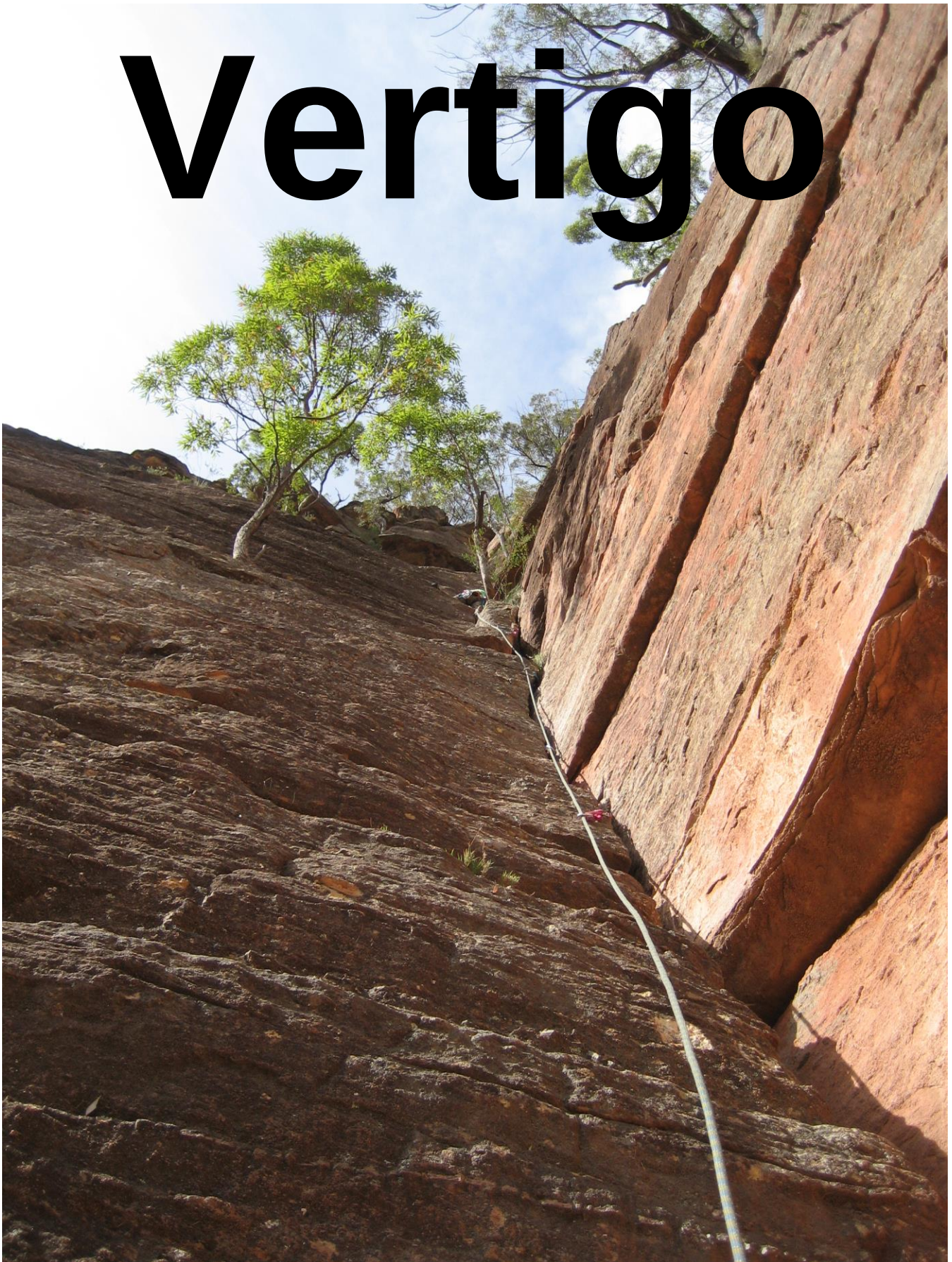


Photo Oliver Dickie leading Grunter (16), Wolgan Valley, Blue Mountains (Photo: Philippa Yasbeck)

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section
www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Section News

No Section Night in June – BANFF is on instead.

Details for BANFF nights are below.

Section Nights are usually at the Tararua Tramping Club clubrooms, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington on the second Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start 8.00 pm with tea & coffee afterwards

Upcoming Events

Remarkables Ice and Mixed festival 14 – 17 August 2014

SO WHATS THIS FESTIVAL ALL ABOUT?

- Bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world.
- Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ.
- Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing.
- Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi pitch winter training area The Remarkables.
- Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships.
- Fundraising for the NZAC expedition fund.

There are limited places available on the clinics and discounts available for NZAC members so be quick to secure your place. Full details on the festival can be found at

<http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#>

North Island Ice Climbing Meet 12-13 July

Now in its third year. This a super popular event where the Auckland, Central North Island, and Wellington sections come together to share their love of climbing ice. Based at the awesome Tukino lodge on the wild side of Mt Ruapehu. Super quick and easy access to a huge amount of water ice. This is not a beginners trip, you should have at a minimum have done a snowcraft course or similar. For more information contact Ant Stead (newsletter@aucklandclimber.org.nz)

NZAC Wellington Snowcraft 2014 Course 15th-17th August

WHAT: Learn snow craft basics – balance and movement, ice axes and crampons and an introduction to mountain awareness.

HOW: One week-night gear and logistics session (30th July) and a weekend away at the Tukino Alpine Sports Club on the eastern flank of Mt Ruapehu (15th-17th August).

COST: \$230 (Includes: accommodation and food). Gear hire and Alpine Club membership are additional costs.

If you are not currently an NZAC member, then you will also be required to join to participate in this course.

The pre-course evening is on Wednesday 30 July 6.00-8.00pm – Bivouac, Mercer Street, Wellington.

If you would like to register for this course, please download the registration form by clicking [here](#).

If you have questions email us at: wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

You can email your completed registration form to the same address as well.



If the weather or conditions prevent the course running on 15th -17th August, an alternate date has been set aside on 29th – 31st August. If the course successfully runs on 15th – 17th August, the alternate weekend would be available for those participants who would like to attend a club trip where they can practise their new found skills.

Cost of NZAC Membership can be found by clicking [here](#)

Benefits of the NZAC membership include:

- A 1 year subscription to the quarterly publication of 'The Climber Magazine'
- A copy of the NZ Alpine Journal.
- Discounted rates on all NZAC huts as well as DOC huts.
- Discounts at selected outdoor retailers and partners.

For a full list of benefits, please visit the NZAC website <http://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

BANFF tickets now on sale

WHERE: Paramount Cinema, 25 Courteney place, Wellington Ph: 3844-080

WHEN: Tuesday 17th June (Programme One) 6:30pm, Tuesday 24th June (Programme Two) 6:30pm and Friday 27th June (Programme One) 6:30pm

COST: \$19 (NZAC members and students) \$21 (non-members)

BOOKING: You can book either by visiting Paramount at their reception desk or use their online booking system by clicking on the links below.

[CLICK HERE for online booking for June 17th Tuesday 6:30pm \(Programme One\)](#)

[CLICK HERE for online booking for June 24th Tuesday 6:30pm \(Programme Two\)](#)

[CLICK HERE for online booking for June 27th Friday 6:30pm \(Programme One\)](#)



Tukino Working Bee Report

On the weekend of 10/11 May, five members of the NZAC Wellington Section headed to Tukino, and the Tukino Alpine Sports Club (TSAC) Lodge. Our unusual mission was not to climb or to ski, but to ready the Lodge for winter, and to make several improvements.

Car one comprised Dan Pringle and Vincent Zintzen. Car two, somewhat delayed, comprised Mark Leslie, Marcus Manning and Allan Brent. Late arrivals led to some amusing ferrying situations under a near-full moon. At the lodge we joined TSAC founder and all-around stalwart Don French and new member, Megan Cook.

The "to do" list was lengthy:

- installing drain for the new hot water cylinder,
- finishing ice-axe and ski racks,
- building a new manager's room, "Dimrill",
- installing trimming on the chase wall's doors,
- painting lots of places,
- fitting a door to the ski-hire room,
- carpet-square gluing,
- making a folding leg for an ingenious folding workbench,
- installing plumbing lagging,
- the reasonably euphemistic "deck support mitigation",
- and much more.



Tukino Alpine Sports Club Lodge (photo Vincent Zintzen)

An early start on Saturday brought power tools to life, a nail gun firing, paint brushes swishing, hammers banging, and all manner of other action. Particularly impressive was Marcus' work constructing two new walls from scratch. Teamwork was required for shifting and shaping several fence posts. Dan and Mark pottered to great effect. Meagan painted well in dusty conditions, while Don kept a watchful eye over all and sundry. A solid day's work brought much of the task list to completion, and much more of it to a well advanced state.

Saturday evening entertainment was provided through enjoying several classic editions of the NZAC Journal (I'm talking late 70s, early 80s) before the fire, and a slide show of some of Don's European travails in the 80s.

Early on Sunday morning, Allan headed out into a perfectly still predawn for a wander up the hill. A wonderfully orange sunrise over the Kaimanawas brought relief and then colour to the morning on the Mangatoetoenui slopes. A col to a sulphury Summit Plateau, then a short snow slope and iced gully took Allan to the top of Tukino. Away to the west, low cloud blanketed the King Country all the way to Taranaki. In all other directions, the waking island wore just scattered cloud. Magic. Return was via a walk-off route, and a descent in bright sunshine completed a morning that had been better than being in bed.



Mt Ruapehu from Tukino (photo Vincent Zintzen)

Meanwhile, the remainder of the crew had set to for another day working on the lodge. With just short breaks, the task above list was near completed, though completion of the "deck support mitigation" project was deferred until a builder could help. And so it was that the TSAC lodge was taken a bunch closer to readiness for the ski season.

Another working bee has been arranged for Queen's Birthday Weekend, whence Tukino will be ready to roll for a great 2014 season.

Trip Reports

A Wintry Summer Traverse of the Remarkables

06 January 2014

Rob Hawes (Leader), Nina Sawicki & Mark Henson

Early summer in Central Otago had a bit of a "wintry start" and I was working as a locum at the new Wanaka Medical Centre over the New Year watching snowflakes dusting the hills around Wanaka. Rob was the "eager weather hawk" watching out for the weather window to climb the North West Ridge of Aspiring but, as so often happens, waiting for the "bigger" window we were lucky to sneak a day in to traverse the Remarkables to avert our cabin fever before another front came through. The "*Rob Hawes Wanaka Alpine Hut*" serves fresh hot tea in bed to budding climbers for small token: making the alpine start a bit less painful! We left Wanaka at 4.00 and started from the top Remarkables car park at about 6.00 am and there was a definite wintry feel with snow and ice capping both cones and the ridge in between. On the preceding day we had been rock climbing at Kai Whaka Pai and had all been involved in the immediate rescue of a rock climber following a ground fall so we carefully reviewed our communication calls prior to the climb.

This traverse must be one of the most magical day alpine hikes in the country involving all of the components of an alpine adventure: commitment, skills test, exposure and amazing views with varying conditions. However we found the rock stable and the compact schist pops out nice holds just when you need them!



*The route (in red) in summer conditions from the Helicopter Pad towards Double Cone
Photo: NZ Alpine Club*

From the car park we followed up into the shadow basin area of the ski-field to the top of the ski-lift and then took the spur that rises left to the crest of the ridge that separated us from the Lake Alta basin. It was very cold and misty and we started off climbing (with down jackets) negotiating patches of verglas and ice. This brought us into the snow bowls above the Lake Alta Cliffs to traverse west to gain the ridge between the weather station and Double Cone. In the snow bowls we were not well prepared for a winter trip (no crampons or ice axes) and Mark was climbing in trail runners so we had to carefully kick in decent steps in the snow for Mark.

A scramble up the ridge took us to the "The Helicopter Pad" (a nice flat spot) indicating the start of the traverse and the ridge rose up immediately: we chose to sidle on the east side on a rising traverse. Aspiring, Tutoko and Earnslaw were clearly visible to the West. By this stage the sun was out but it was still very cold.



Nina climbing up the cleft to the ridge to Double Cone : Snow and verglas in patches Photo: Mark Henson

We reached a substantial cleft (pictured above) and climbed directly, steeply up but there was good sound rock and holds (the occasional patch of ice to watch out for). Once on the top ridge you can turn on the eastern side (which was exposed) but which has good holds.



Looking back down to Mark ascending the cleft up to Double Cone Photo: Nina Sawicki



Rob in the foreground with a view back to the Helipad Photo: Mark Henson



Mark on the Final Ascent up to the Ridge Photo: Nina Sawicki

Once on the ridge top we climbed on the spine again, quietly breathing with the exposure on the top of the ridge: probably the crux of the climb! Topping out on Double Cone was probably the highlight and felt like "the summit" (although Single Cone is actually higher). Verglas and patches of snow were our constant companions so we needed the rope out quite a few times. We then descended into the grand couloir toward Lake Alta before traversing

shelves east of the main gully. From the couloir it was a straightforward rising traverse on the eastern side under the ridge gendarmes and then directly up the Ridge (a small step across a groove) and then an approximately 30m scramble to the top of Single Cone. We met quite a few happy climbers on the summit one of whom was very hungry so I lost a sandwich (to a good cause though). The majority had just come up Single Cone and not done the full traverse.



Rob and Nina climbing up to the summit of Single Cone Photo: Mark Henson



Rob on the summit of Single Cone Photo: Nina Sawicki



Looking back at the traverse: Looking South West with Lake Wakatipu in the foreground Photo: Nina Sawicki

We descended by the couloir to the south where there were plenty of abseil bolts. There was a mixture of rock and very soft unstable snow at the bottom of this chute so we were very grateful for the rope. From there it was a scramble back down to Lake Alta and the car park by 4.00 pm. We were home back for a gourmet vegetarian feast back in Wanaka that evening.



Abseil off the Summit of Single Cone Photo: Rob Hawes

Moderate climbing in the Blue Mountains

Philippa Yasbeck

Being a middling climber, it's often hard to find destinations that offer a variety of climbing. It was with some trepidation that I browsed an old Blue Mountains climbing guide. It seemed to be either fantastic sport climbing in the mid 20s (out of my league) or easy trad on chossy rock. We arrived to find that a new guidebook had been published and there has been quite a bit of development in the more moderate grades.



Oliver Dickie seconding the third pitch of Sweet Dreams (14) at Sublime Point, Blue Mountains.

We piled in to our tiny rental car with a bad wheel wobble and headed out to Barden's Lookout for a warm up on our first day. I blamed the jet lag when I had to grab a draw on a 16. The rock is sandstone (and sometimes just sand) with bands of ironstone that weathers more slowly. Lots of crimping on little edges and some big reaches. Stick clipping is the norm (and openly encouraged).

After a few days of sport climbing, it was time to crack out the rack. We headed over to Mt Piddington for a Ewbank homage (pioneering Australian climber who invented our grading system) on naturally protected routes, put up by the great man himself. I led The Eternity (18), a beautiful zig-zagging hand crack. It's described as one of the best climbs in Australia (at the grade). It was definitely worth doing: sustained and varied. It even requires good crack climbing technique! There was some minor dissent from the second who hadn't packed his crack climbing shoes. I then decided to do The Phantom (13). I thought it may be a bit harder

than a modern 13, when the guide said it had it all: a V1 boulder move start, a hand traverse and purple undies. I didn't manage the on sight, because it took me three tries before I managed to pull the first move. There was about five metres of ordinary grade 13 climbing before a hand traverse (one of the few places in the Blueys that was easier for the vertically challenged) and then the piece de resistance: an overhanging head wall with no protection.

There were some minor tensions as I wanted to do more trad and Oli wanted to work some sport routes, but we managed to get in both. Oli successfully projected two 21s at Shipley Upper, which I worked more half-heartedly. We did a great 180 metre 14 (Sweet Dreams) at Leura, with fantastic views out towards The Three Sisters. We also did an incredible three pitch, bolted 18 on The Bellbird Wall with an amazingly intimidating final pitch, starting in a chimney and traversing out for some exposure. We felt less heroic after lunch when we went to the lookout and watched some people string up a very long slack line over a deep gorge. None of them managed to walk across, as the high wind made the line too wobbly.

We finished off the trip with a couple of days up the Wolgan Valley. The climbing was good, but not quite as exciting as spotting wombats in the evening.

The Blueys are a great destination, whatever your climbing grade. There are beautiful walks and runs for rest days, and decent coffee. Thanks to Marty for all the beta!

Notices

2014 NZ Alpine Club Photographic Competition

Entries are open for the 2014 NZAC Photographic Competition. Rules, information and a useful document written by Mark Watson providing tips for better climbing photos can be found at <https://alpineclub.org.nz/photocomp>.

Benefits for Alpine Club members

There are numerous benefits available to Alpine Club members. For details see <https://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

Short-term offers

Summit 8000 by Andrew Lock

20% discount on preorders and online sales of [Summit 8000 by Andrew Lock](#).

Craig Potton Publishing

As new publications are released, specific titles will be made available to NZAC members at a 20% discount. The current offer and time limit to redeem the offer are detailed below.

Information on the books' content may be found in the attached PDFs:

Current Applicable titles:

- New Zealand Whitewater ISBN 9780473260941 RRP \$34.99
- Above the Treeline ISBN 9781877517761 RRP \$49.99

Discount and discount code:-

- 20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (obtained from [Margaret](#), or [Narina](#))
- Free Freight within New Zealand

Dates available:

- 1st March 2014 until 30th June 2014

Link to the Craig Potton Publishing website:-

- <http://www.craigpotton.co.nz/>

Tukino Alpine Sports Club – Hut Warden wanted

The Tukino Alpine Sports Club is looking for a hut warden for the coming winter, from mid-June to early October.

The warden – or “Lodge Manager” as we call it - will be resident at our lodge at Tukino Alpine Village, with the job of welcoming and helping guests, and helping manage the lodge facilities. Guests do most of the work, but need some guidance.

Hours are light, and you can ski or climb during the day. A room, food and cash allowance is provided. We can also help with a ski pass at Tukino depending on how long you are signing up for.

We are happy to receive enquiries covering any amount of time. The warden's room can fit two, so couples / pairs welcome to apply.

Skiing is a big deal at Tukino. But we are also affiliated to the NZAC and ice climbing, mountaineering and backcountry skiing are a big part of the scene.

What is essential? You must love mountains, and like people - or is that the other way round? It's a beautiful place. A practical bent and some previous experience would help too.

Contact secretary@tukinoalpinsportsclub.org.nz if you're interested.

For more info on the lodge visit www.tukinoalpinestportsclub.org.nz

(The New Zealand Alpine Club (NZAC) has a partnership agreement with the Tukino Alpine Sports Club (TASC) that allows NZAC members to book the lodge at member rates.)

NZ International Film Festival

The New Zealand International Film Festival (NZIFF) is approaching its programme launch, for films screening during July, August and September. We think anyone with a love of **mountaineering** will be interested in one of the films in particular and we wanted you to be among the first to hear about it: ***The Epic of Everest*** will be screening in Auckland, Wellington, Dunedin and Christchurch.

The Epic of Everest

The official film of the ill-fated 1924 attempt at Everest has been spectacularly restored by the British Film Institute. It's the most majestic and spooked of age-of-conquest documentaries, reverberant with the intimations of nature's indifference that the filmmakers could scarcely ignore when reviewing their remarkable footage. A new musical soundtrack by Simon Fisher Turner, utilising electronica alongside Nepalese instruments, underscores the haunting effect. "In June 1924 George Mallory and Andrew Irvine walked to their deaths, disappearing from the view of their fellow explorers on the north-east ridge of Mount Everest. That there was a film-maker, with a customised camera and a telephoto lens, on hand to record any of their final steps is impressive, even when viewed from the age of citizen photojournalism... Modern viewers may squirm at the contrast between Noel's reverent approach to the mountain and his condescension toward the Tibetan locals. But it's the chill grandeur of his images, and the mystical note in his rueful conclusion, that will linger in your mind." — Pamela Hutchison, *The Guardian*

"This is one of the greatest treasures of the BFI National Archive. It represents a key moment in the history of mountaineering and remains an enduring monument to Mallory and Irvine." — Robin Baker, BFI National Archive

Exact details of session dates and venues will be announced closer to the opening of NZIFF. As this film is yet to be publicly announced it is not yet listed on our website so for further information about the film, or to discuss reserving group bookings before tickets go on sale to the public, please contact Debbie Fish on 04 802 2576.

To keep up to date with NZIFF programme as it is announced, visit our website at www.nziff.co.nz.

Scott's Last Expedition – new website

A new website that chronicles and commemorates Robert Falcon Scott's 1910-1913 expedition is now available at <http://www.scottslastexpedition.org/expedition/>.

An online exhibition was created by the Antarctic Heritage Trust as a lasting record of the award-winning centenary exhibition, Scott's Last Expedition, that toured internationally, a collaboration between the Antarctic Heritage Trust (New Zealand), Natural History Museum, London, and Canterbury Museum (New Zealand).

Wellington Section 2012/13 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Email alias*	Contact
Chairperson	Dan Pringle	chairperson	027 768-2185
Vice Chair	Vincent Zintzen	vicechair	
Secretary	Julian Davidson	secretary or CM2	
Treasurer	Adam Newberry	treasurer	
National Rep	Dan Pringle		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Vacant	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Simon Williamson		
	John Yu		
	Sharran Came		
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	vacant	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	vacant		
Instruction - Rock	vacant		
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Carolyn Ellis		Kaz1963@gmail.com
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	John Yu	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Sam Newton	sam@alpineclub.org.nz



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